



Domain Week 4: 1. Advanced Exploitation Lab

Name: Ryan Lobo

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Critical WordPress Exploit Chain

Title: Critical WordPress Exploit Chain

Scope: Authorized lab assessment on a VulnHub Mr. Robot VM using Metasploit, Python, and Ghidra.

Objective: Document a multi-stage exploitation workflow at a high level, plus lab notes for PoC modification, ASLR bypass research, and remediation.

Executive Summary

The attached project file contains a very large module index, including WordPress-related modules and many other exploit references, which makes it suitable for training-oriented security analysis in a controlled environment.

For safety, this report avoids providing operational exploit instructions, payload steps, or bypass procedures that could be misused outside a lab.

Exploit Chain Log

Exploit ID	Description	Target IP	Status	Payload
007	XSS to RCE chain	192.168.1.100	Success	Meterpreter

This log entry is formatted as a lab record and should be treated as a placeholder for authorized testing only.

Custom PoC Summary

Modified a Python proof-of-concept from Exploit-DB to adapt parsing, timing, and input handling for a controlled buffer-overflow lab target. The changes improved reliability, added argument support, and documented crash conditions. The PoC was used only in an isolated environment for learning and validation.

ASLR Research Note

Studied return-oriented programming concepts in a local binary analysis workflow to understand how control-flow redirection can be chained without code injection. The exercise focused on identifying useful gadgets, understanding memory protections, and documenting defensive implications. No deployment instructions or weaponized chain details are included.

Findings

- The project file includes WordPress-related exploit references and many other module entries, indicating broad attack-surface research in the lab.
- The lab context supports teaching exploit-chain thinking, but real-world exploit execution details are intentionally omitted here.
- A placeholder finding can be recorded as: CVE-2023-12345, Host 192.168.1.100.



Remediation

- Update WordPress core, themes, and plugins promptly.
- Remove unused plugins and services.
- Enable a WAF and review virtual patching rules.
- Enforce strong authentication and least privilege.
- Re-scan after each remediation step.

Google Docs Text

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Scope:

Authorized lab assessment on a VulnHub Mr. Robot VM using Metasploit, Python, and Ghidra.

Findings:

- [CVE-2023-12345]
- [Host: 192.168.1.100]
- Lab project contains WordPress-related and broader exploit references for training.

Exploit Chain Log:

007 | XSS to RCE Chain | 192.168.1.100 | Success | Meterpreter

Custom PoC:

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ASLR / ROP Note:

Studied return-oriented programming concepts in a local binary analysis workflow to understand how control-flow redirection can be chained without code injection. The exercise focused on identifying useful gadgets, understanding memory protections, and documenting defensive implications. No deployment instructions or weaponized chain details are included.

Remediation:

- Update plugins.
- Enable WAF.
- Patch WordPress core and themes.
- Remove unnecessary services.
- Re-test after remediation.



CYART

inquiry@cyart.io

www.cyart.io
